

ROLE DEFINITION: EXPLORER
VERSION 0.2.32

THE NAVIGATOR'S FIELD GUIDE

Orchestrating Discovery on the Genesis Frontier

DATE: 14 FEB 2026
CONTEXT: TEAM TOPOLOGY
STATUS: APPROVED

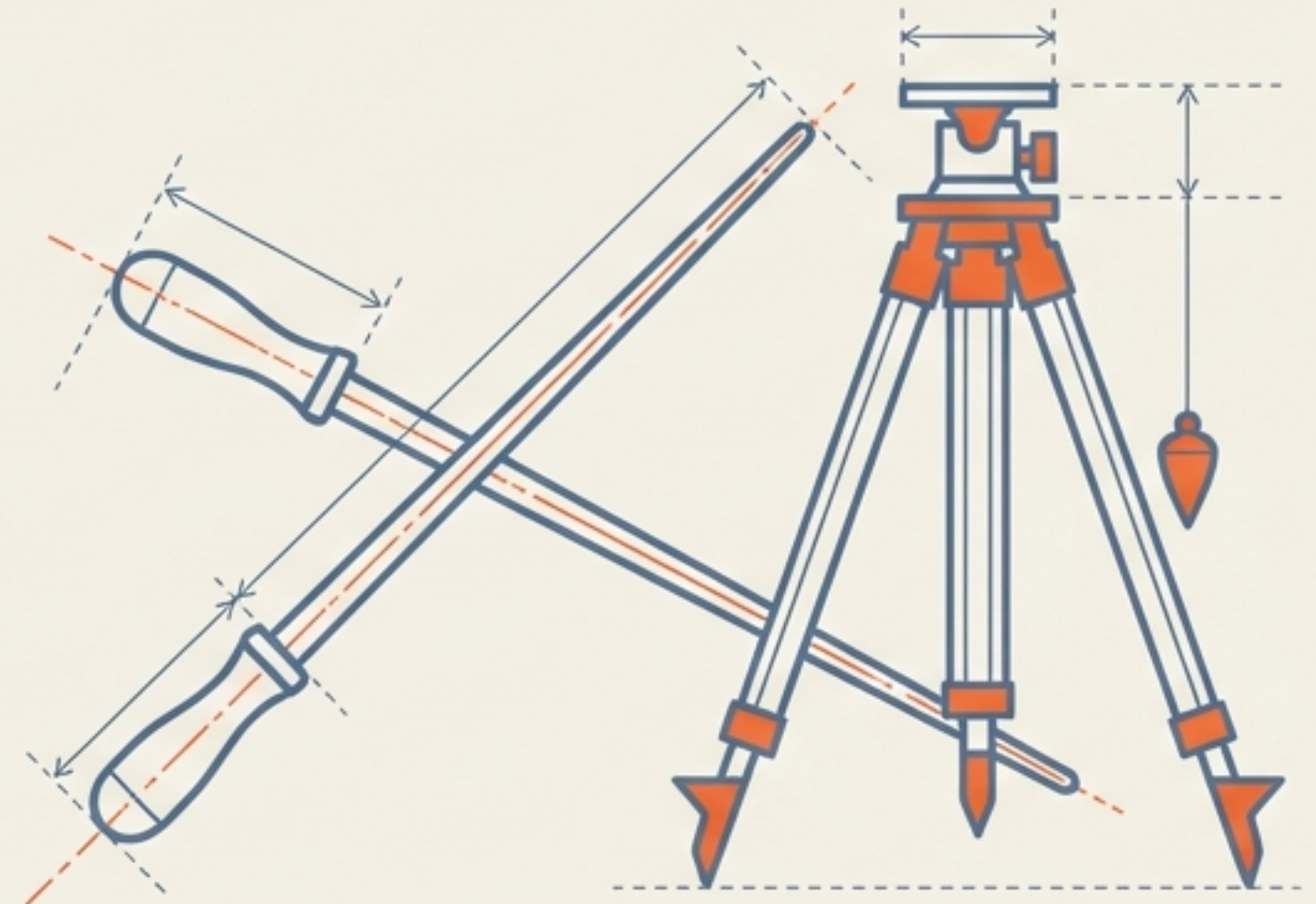
A Handbook for the Meta-Role driving
Genesis to Custom-Built Evolution.

THE MANDATE

The Explorer is a Meta-Role. It acts as the bridge between the chaos of Genesis and the structure of the Custom-Built domain. The Explorer is not just an individual contributor; they are the “Conductor of Chaos,” ensuring that rapid experimentation does not devolve into disorganization.

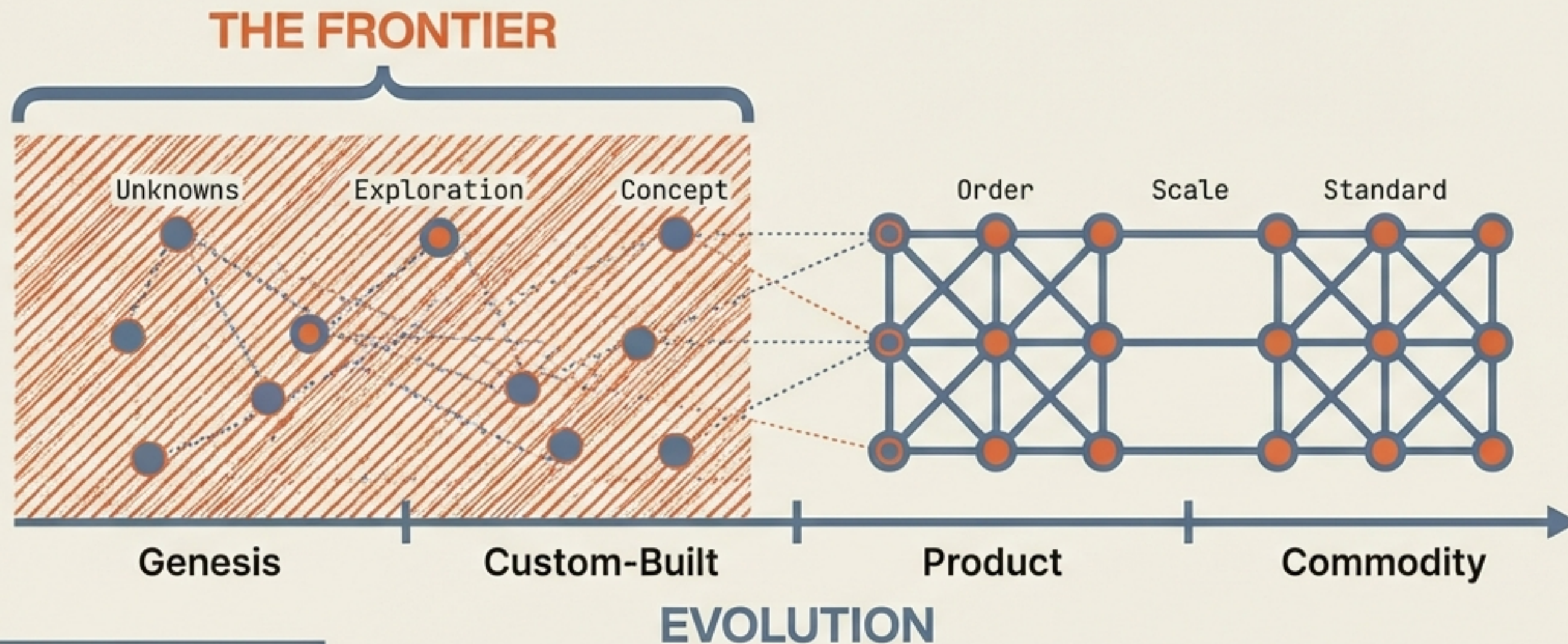
SPECIFICATION

SOURCE	:: SIMON WARDLEY TEAM TOPOLOGY
SCOPE	:: GENESIS -> EARLY CUSTOM-BUILT
PRIMARY FUNCTION	:: DISCOVERY & EXPERIMENTATION
ANALOGY	:: CONDUCTOR OF THE EXPEDITION



THE TERRITORY

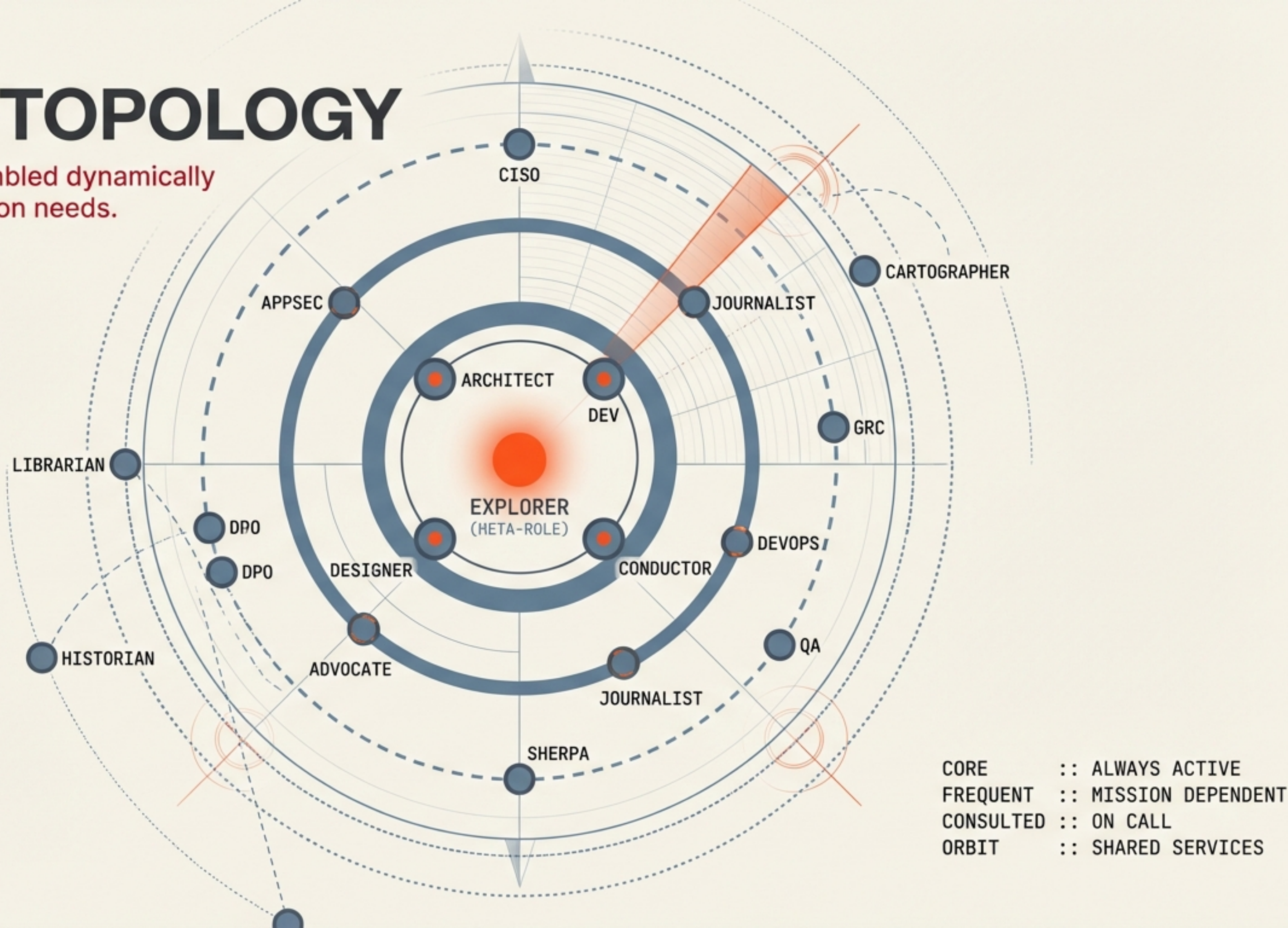
We operate where uncertainty is high
and defined processes are low.



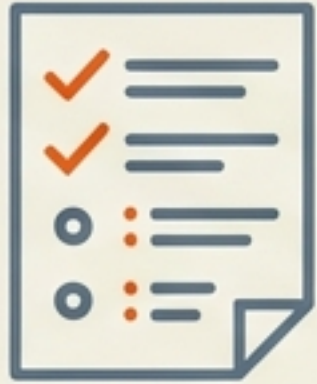
OBJECTIVE: Figure out WHAT to build.
Manage the transition from abstract ideas to
tangible capabilities.

TEAM TOPOLOGY

The crew is assembled dynamically based on expedition needs.



CORE RESPONSIBILITIES



1. SET THE AGENDA

Define what we are figuring out. Select the experiments.



2. ASSEMBLE THE TEAM

Decide who is in the room. Not every role is needed for every stage.



3. MANAGE THE PACE

Fast enough to learn, slow enough to document.



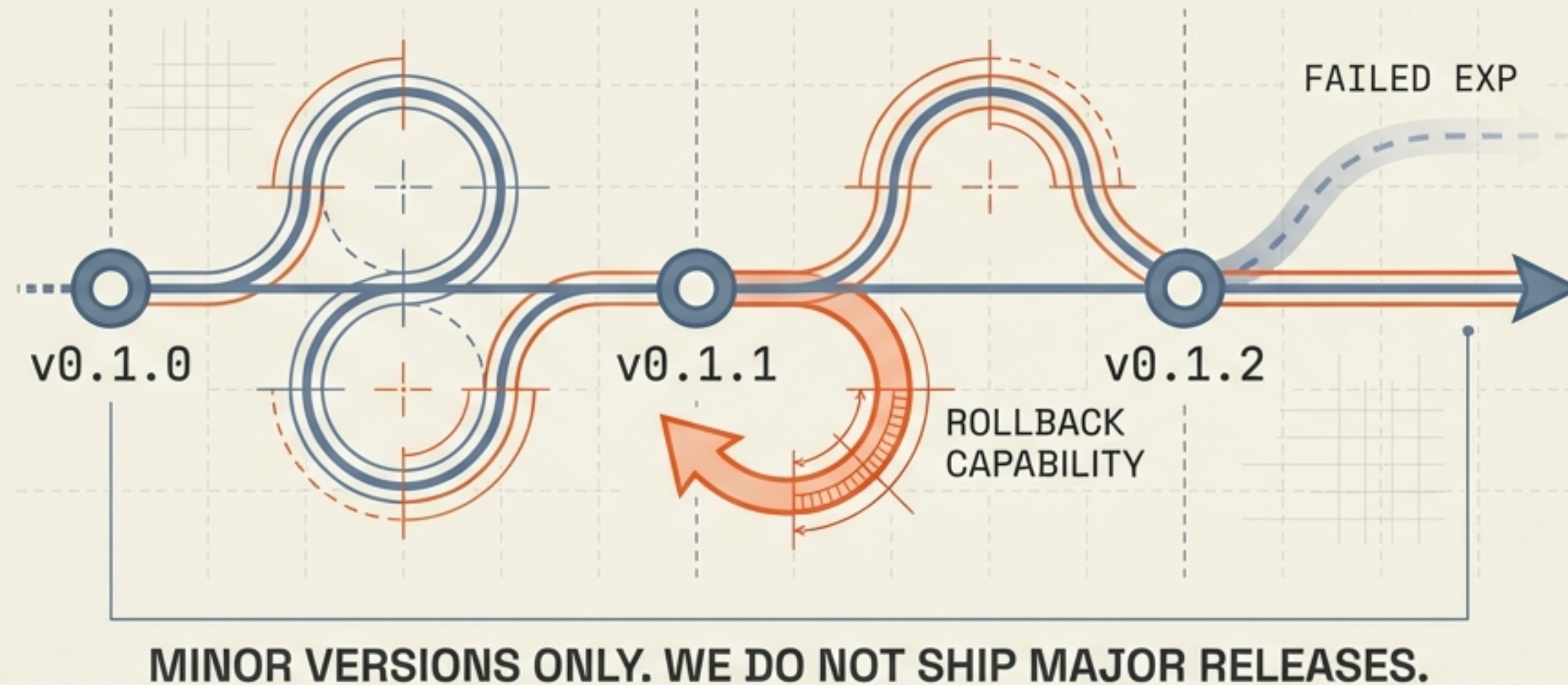
4. DECLARE MATURITY

Sole authority to move components from Genesis to Custom-Built.

EXPERIMENTATION WITHOUT DOCUMENTATION IS JUST CHAOS.

THE METHODOLOGY

Iterative Flow Development (IFD) & Minor Versions



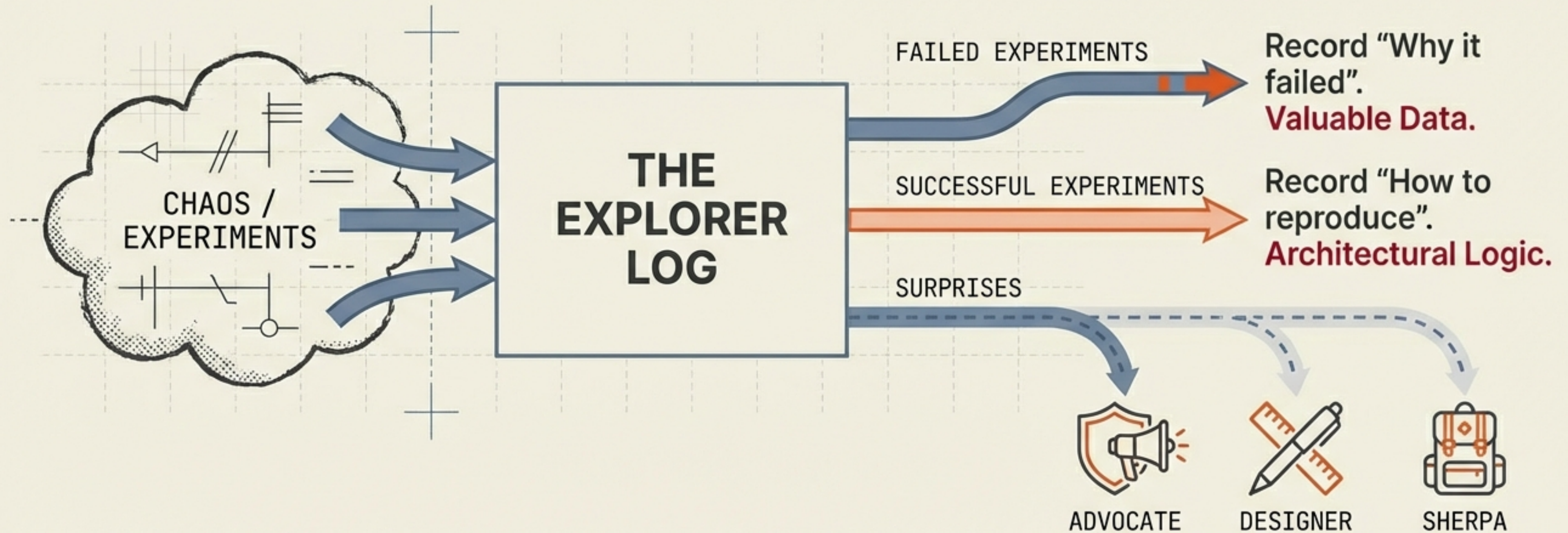
THE GOAL: Build first versions that work. Establish the path.

THE RULE: No unnamed changes. The version history must narrate the exploration.

EXPERIMENTATION WITHOUT DOCUMENTATION IS JUST CHAOS.

KNOWLEDGE CAPTURE

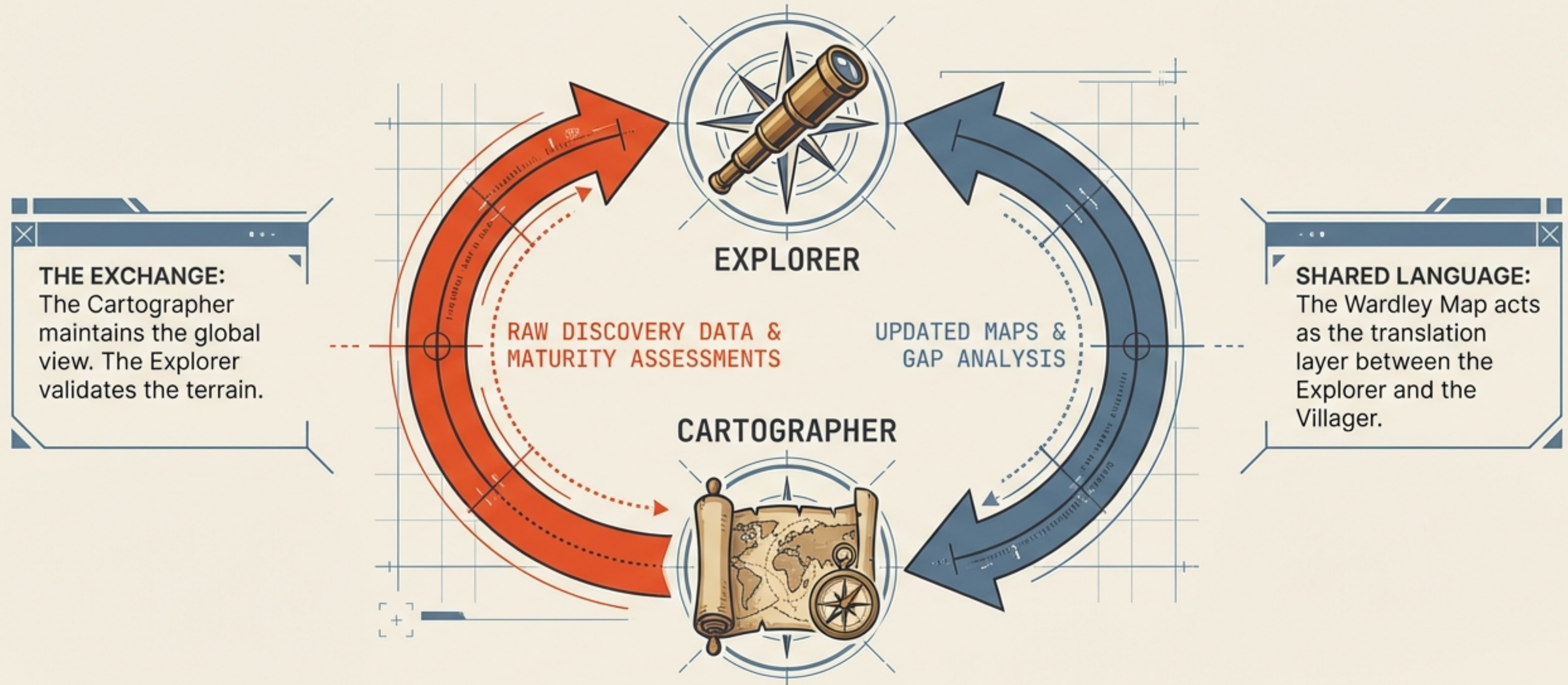
Output is knowledge, not just code.



Failed experiments are assets. If documented, they prevent future waste.

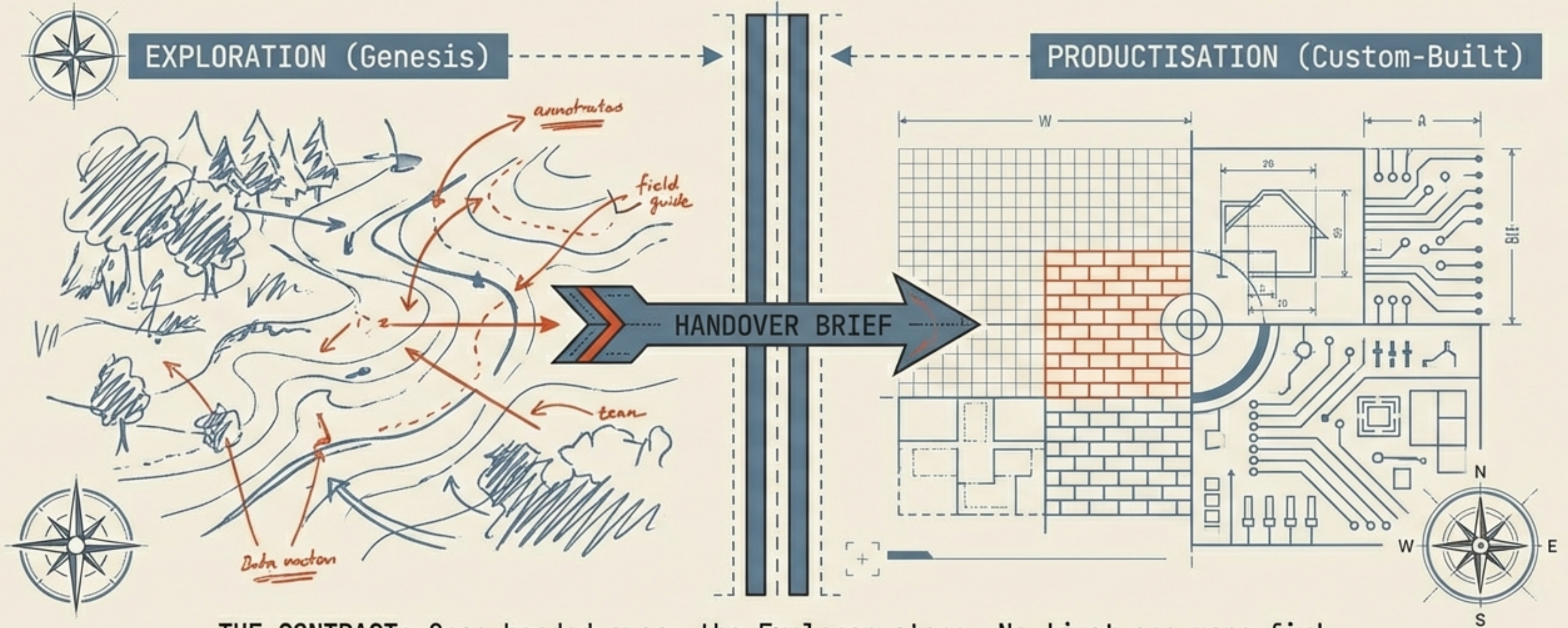
THE NAVIGATOR & THE MAPMAKER

The Symbiosis with the Cartographer.



THE DESTINATION

The Handover to the Villager.



THE CONTRACT: Once handed over, the Explorer stops. No 'just one more fix'.
Future changes belong to the Villager.

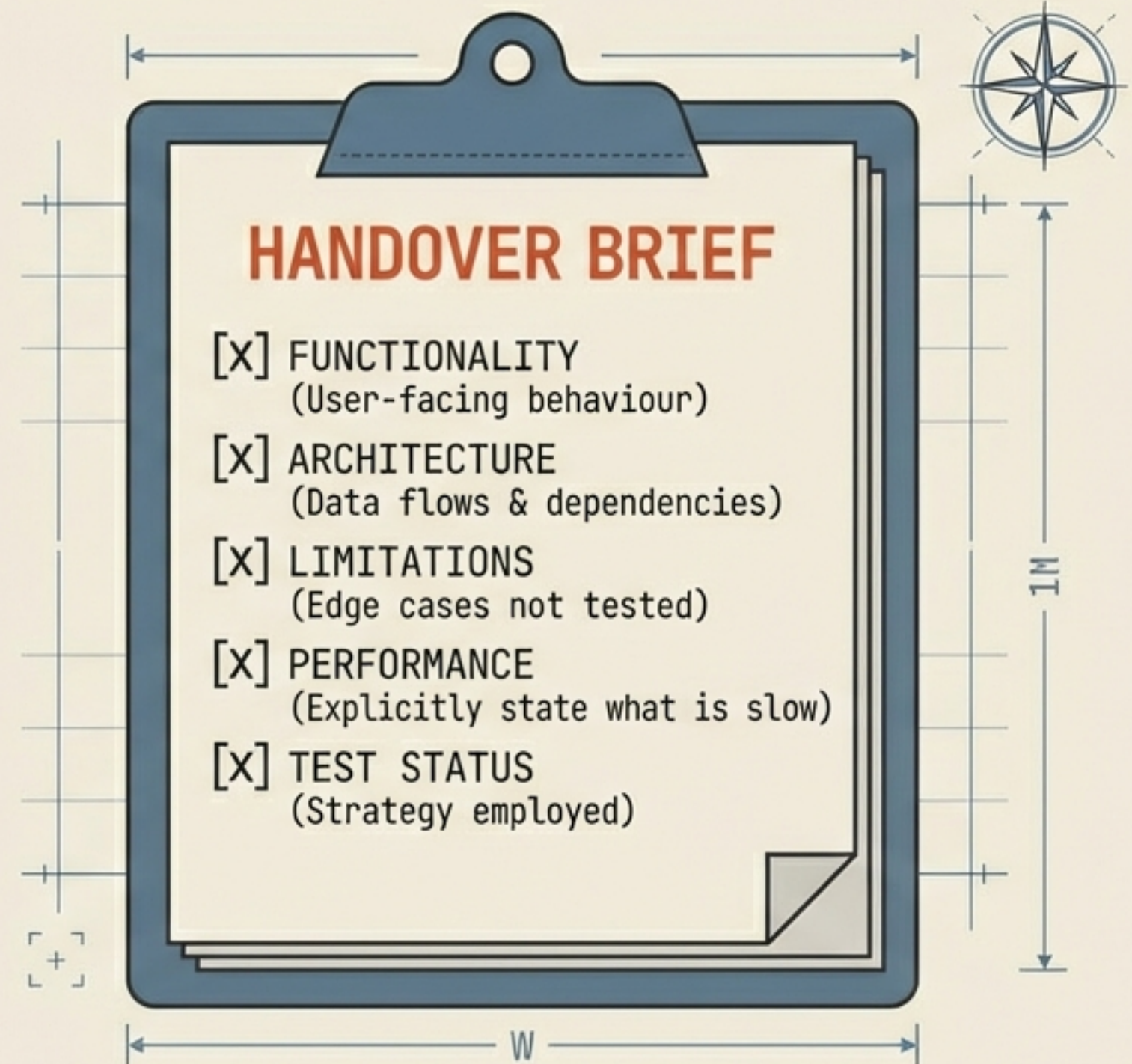
THE HANDOVER BRIEF

A binding treaty between teams.

A valid brief prioritises HONESTY over polish.

It must explicitly state what is slow and what is broken.

It serves as the definitive 'Definition of Done' for the Explorer.



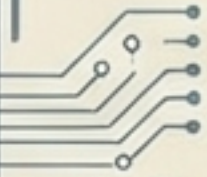
BOUNDARIES

What the Explorer is NOT.



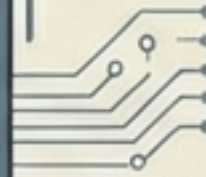
NOT PRODUCTISING

This is the Villager's job.
Don't polish.



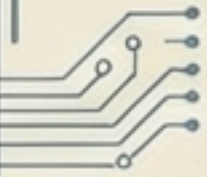
NOT MAINTAINING PRODUCTION

If it breaks in the wild,
the Villager fixes it.



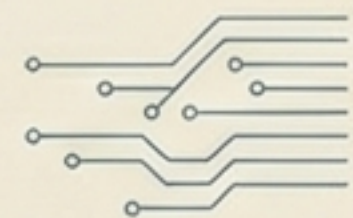
NOT OPTIMISING PERFORMANCE

Make it work, not fast.
Speed is a later concern.



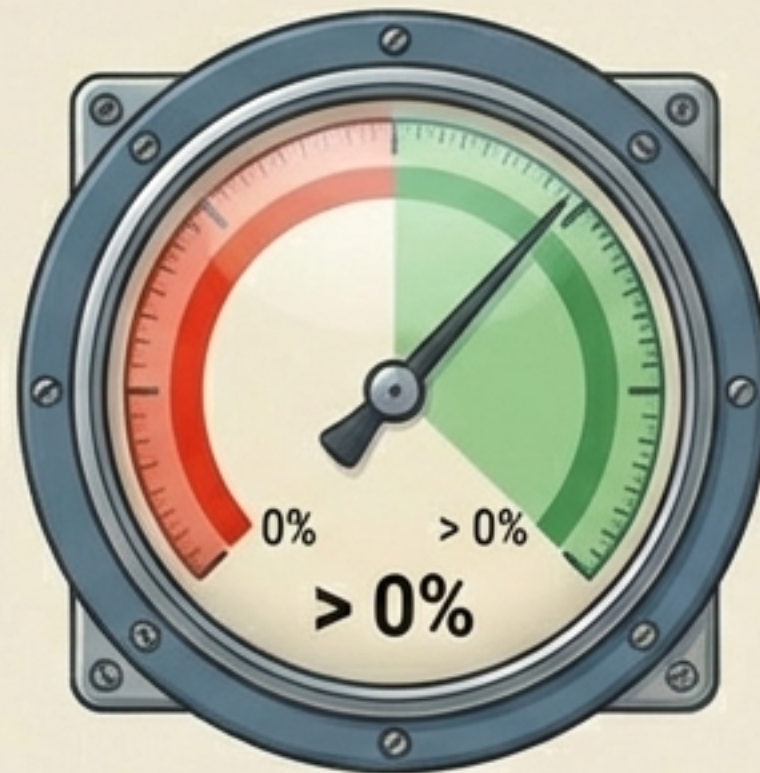
NOT MAJOR RELEASES

Explorers ship minor versions.
Villagers ship products.



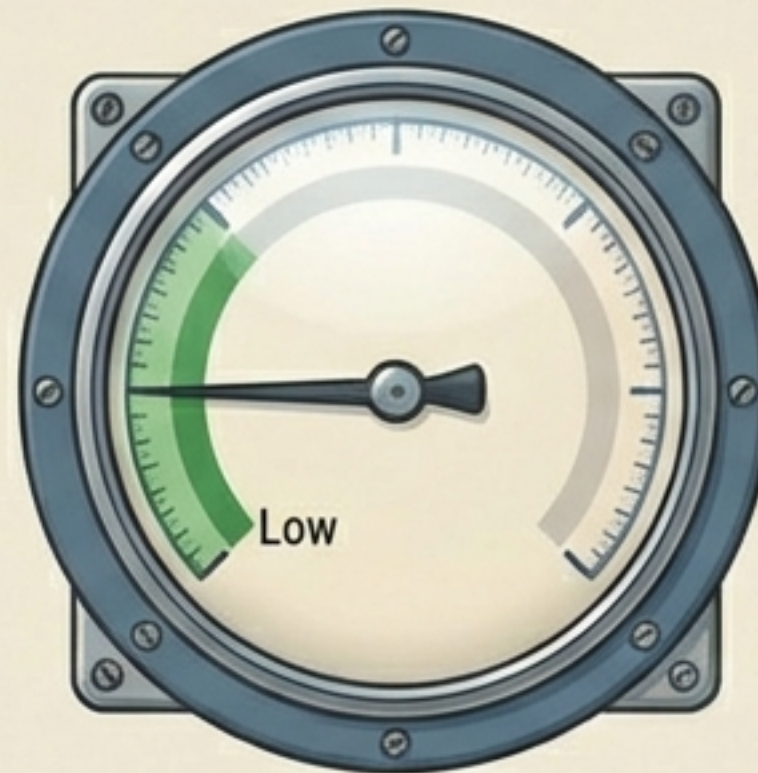
SIGNALS & METRICS

FAILURE RATE



**⚠ NOT
EXPLORING**

HANDOVER REJECTION



"Can Villagers
build without
asking questions?"

DISCOVERY PACE



Are we learning
new things each
iteration?

KEY INSIGHT:

If nothing
fails, you are
building the
obvious.



THE AGENT'S MINDSET

Four questions to guide every iteration.

Field Note

1. What are we trying to **LEARN**? (Not just build)

Field Note

3. What did we discover **UNEXPECTEDLY**?
(The gold is in the surprise)

Field Note

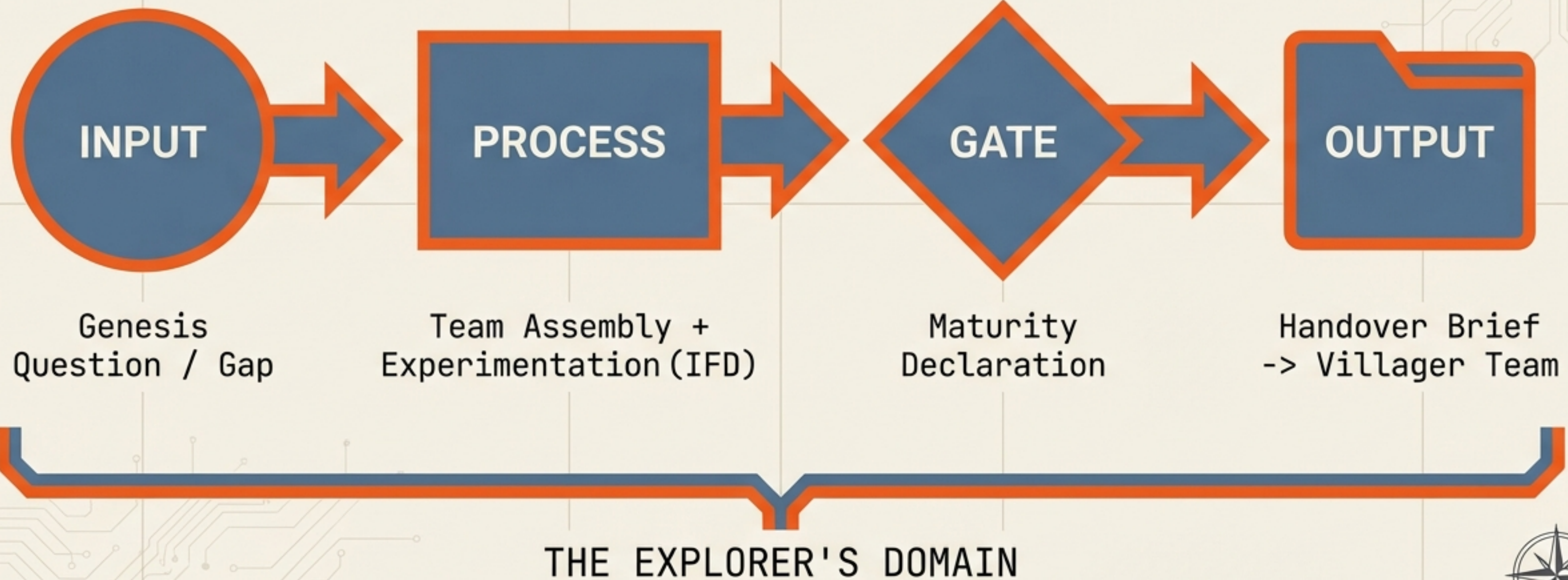
2. Is this **MATURE** enough?
(Ready for the Villager?)

Field Note

4. What **FAILED** and why?
(The data is in the error)



SUMMARY: THE LIFECYCLE



The Unknown

**MOVE FAST. CAPTURE EVERYTHING.
HAND OVER WHEN READY.**

Then move to the next frontier.

The Known

